

Freelancer Client Onboarding Kit: 6 Done-for-You Templates

RenWork Digital Products

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Stop losing momentum after the contract is signed. These six templates are designed to streamline

your first week with a new client, eliminate ambiguity, and set a professional tone that protects your time and budget. Copy, paste, and personalize these documents to transform your onboarding from

a chaotic scramble into a seamless, high-value experience.

1. The Welcome Email (Project Confirmed)

****Subject:**** Welcome to the team, [Client Name]! Next steps for [Project Name]

Hi [Client Name],

I am thrilled to officially join forces with you on [Project Name]. It's a privilege to work with [Company Name], and I'm excited to see what we can achieve together.

Now that the contract is signed, here is exactly what happens next so we can hit the ground running:

1. ****Kickoff Questionnaire:**** I've just sent you a link to a brief questionnaire. Please fill this out by [Date/Time]. This helps me understand your goals, audience, and brand voice before we begin.
2. ****Onboarding Checklist:**** Attached is a checklist outlining the assets and access I need from you. Please review the "Client Actions" section and send over the requested materials by [Date].
3. ****Kickoff Call:**** I've proposed [Date] at [Time] for a 30-minute kickoff call. This is our chance to align on expectations, review the timeline, and answer any initial questions.

If any of the above deadlines feel tight, please let me know immediately so we can adjust.

Otherwise, I'll see your responses in my inbox soon.

Looking forward to building something great.

Best,

[Your Name]

2. Project Kickoff Questionnaire

Send this via a form tool like Typeform, Tally, or a simple Google Form. Keep the intro brief.

****Instructions:**** Please answer the following questions as thoroughly as possible. Your answers will directly impact the strategy and execution of your project. There are no wrong answers, but more detail helps me do my job better.

****Goals & Strategy****

1. What is the primary business goal of this project? (e.g., lead generation, brand awareness, user retention)
2. How will you measure the success of this project? (Specific KPIs, e.g., "Increase signups by 15%")
3. Who is the target audience for this deliverable? Please describe their demographics, pain points, and motivations.
4. What is the single most important message you want the audience to take away?

****Brand & Voice****

5. In three words, how would you describe your brand's personality? (e.g., Professional, Playful, Luxurious)
6. Who are two competitors or brands you admire for their tone/voice? Why?
7. Who are two brands you **do not** want to sound like? Why?
8. Are there specific words, phrases, or slang your brand always uses or strictly avoids?

****Deliverables & Content****

9. Please list all specific deliverables required (e.g., 5 blog posts, one landing page, 3 social graphics).
10. For each deliverable, is there a specific format, word count, or dimension requirement?
11. Do you have existing content, case studies, or past projects I should reference for tone and accuracy? Please share links.

12. Are there any technical constraints or platform-specific requirements I should know about?

****Success & Logistics****

13. Who is the final decision-maker for approvals?

14. What is the ideal timeline for this project? Are there any hard deadlines (launches, events)?

15. What are your biggest concerns or fears regarding this project?

16. What has worked well in past campaigns/projects with other freelancers or agencies?

17. What has gone wrong in the past that you want to avoid this time?

18. Is there any sensitive information or internal context I need to know before starting?

19. How would you like to receive drafts? (PDF, Word Doc, Figma, Loom video)

20. Is there anything else I should know about your brand or this project?

3. Onboarding Checklist

Attach this as a PDF or include it in your project management tool (Asana, Trello, ClickUp).

****Client Actions (Required by [Date])****

* ☐ Sign and return the executed contract.

* ☐ Complete the Project Kickoff Questionnaire.

* ☐ Provide login credentials for necessary platforms (e.g., WordPress, Canva, Ad Account) -

Please use a password manager or email credentials securely.

* ☐ Share brand assets: Logo files (SVG/PNG), brand guidelines, font files, and color palette.

* ☐ Share any relevant case studies, previous work, or sample content.

* ☐ Confirm the kickoff call time.

****Freelancer Setup (Completed by [Date])****

* ☐ Create a dedicated project folder in cloud storage (ShareDrive/S3).

* ☐ Set up the project board in the project management tool.

* ☐ Schedule the kickoff call and send the calendar invite.

* ☐ Review the signed contract and questionnaire.

* ☐ Draft the initial project timeline based on questionnaire responses.

* ☐ Send the first invoice (deposit) if not already paid.

4. Communication Expectations One-Pager

****Response Times & Availability****

* ****My Availability:**** I am available [Days of Week] from [Start Time] to [End Time] [Time Zone].

* **Response Time:** I aim to respond to all emails and messages within 24-48 hours on business days. For urgent matters, please flag them with "URGENT" in the subject line.

* **Preferred Channel:** Please use [Email/Slack/Asana] for all project-related communication to keep a central record. Avoid texting unless explicitly agreed upon for emergencies.

Feedback & Revision Policy

* **Feedback Window:** I request consolidated feedback within [Number] business days after delivering a draft. If I do not hear from you within this window, I will assume the work is approved.

* **Revision Rounds:** The initial quote includes [Number] rounds of revisions. Revisions include minor tweaks to wording, layout, or formatting.

* **Note:** Major changes that alter the core strategy, scope, or direction outlined in the questionnaire may be considered "out of scope" and will require a change order or additional fee.

* **Consolidated Feedback:** To maximize efficiency, please provide all feedback in one document or comment thread per deliverable, rather than sending multiple emails with piecemeal notes.

Escalation

If we do not hear back from you within [Number] days, the project timeline will shift accordingly. If the project is paused for more than [Number] days, a reactivation fee of [Amount/%] may apply to restart work.

5. Project Timeline Template

Customize the dates based on your contract.

Phase 1: Discovery & Planning

* **Start Date:** [Date]

* **End Date:** [Date]

* **Milestones:**

* [Date]: Kickoff Call

* [Date]: Questionnaire & Assets Received

* [Date]: Strategy/Outline Approved

* **Client Review Window:** [Date] - [Date]

Phase 2: Production/Execution

- * **Start Date:** [Date]
- * **End Date:** [Date]
- * **Milestones:**
 - * [Date]: First Drafts Delivered
 - * [Date]: Second Drafts (Revisions 1) Delivered
 - * [Date]: Final Polishing & QA
- * **Client Review Window:** [Date] - [Date]

Phase 3: Final Delivery & Handover

- * **Start Date:** [Date]
- * **End Date:** [Date]
- * **Milestones:**
 - * [Date]: Final Files Delivered
 - * [Date]: Final Payment Due
 - * [Date]: Project Closure & Feedback
- * **Client Review Window:** Immediate upon delivery

Key Dependencies:

- * Client feedback must be received within [Number] days of draft delivery to keep the timeline on track.
- * Delays in client feedback will push the final delivery date by the same amount of time.

6. Scope Creep Response Script

Use this script when a client requests work that falls outside the original agreement. Do not apologize. Be polite, clear, and business-like.

Scenario: Client asks for an extra deliverable or a major change mid-project.

Script:

"Thanks for sharing that new idea, [Client Name]. It's a great addition to the project.

However, looking at our signed contract and the original scope, this specific request ([briefly describe the new request]) falls outside the agreed-upon deliverables. The current rate and timeline were calculated based on the original scope of [briefly list original scope].

To accommodate this new request, I can offer you two options:

1. **Change Order:** We can add this to the current project.